

RESILIENT ROOTS Satyam Sundaram with handcrafted bamboo products

sweetness. The showroom is crowded: sofa sets surrounded by delicate handbags, toothbrushes, tongue cleaners, thermos flasks, pen holders, toys; hundreds of bamboo artefacts line the walls. The factory—which stands on the two *kathas* of land (around 2,800 sq. ft) his father purchased—hums with activity. A bamboo-cutting machine slices cleanly through thick canes; polishing wheels turn in quiet rhythm; a generator stands ready for peak orders.

Since its inauguration in May 2022 by Bihar's then industry minister Shahnawaz Hussain, Manipuri Bamboo Architecture has grown into a Rs 40 lakh-a-year enterprise. Three franchise partners handle select cities; online sales are managed by Satyam, while his mother, Asha Anuragini, runs the thriving local outlet. The workshop team—many originally trained by master craftsmen from Manipur and Assam—works with seamless precision.

From everyday cutlery to finely carved portraits and bamboo maps of India, each creation challenges plastic and celebrates resilience. "Bamboo bends, it doesn't break," Satyam says. "That's been my story too." ■

"AN MBA TAUGHT ME THE RIGOUR OF MARKETING AND HOW TO SPOT GAPS IN SUPPLY, BUT IT WAS MY MOTHER'S UNWAVERING WILL THAT KEPT ME MOVING WHEN THE NUMBERS AND THE ODDS SAID STOP"

SATYAM SUNDARAM